

Workshop: Searching by bar

Wouldn't it be easy if you could search the Web directly, without waiting for the Web page of a search engine to load? It is, given the right tools. You can set the toolbar of the search engine of your choice (Google, Opera, Netscape, etc.) on your desktop, and search from there.

Download and install Google toolbar from <http://toolbar.google.com/>. Double-click the Internet Explorer icon on the desktop to load IE.. Next, right-click on any of the toolbars, you will see additional options such as Links, Addresses, Standard Buttons, etc. Click on 'Google' to load the toolbar. The toolbar has a text field, and buttons—"Search the Web", 'Navigate the Google News site', a graphical button to block pop-ups, an Autofill tool for Web forms, a blog updater and a button that enables or disables the highlighting of search words on the resultant page.

To search, just enter the search string into the text field of the Google toolbar and hit [Enter]. You can also specify Boolean text searches in the same text field area.

The Google deskbar

The Google Deskbar (<http://toolbar.google.com/deskbar/>) is an add-on to your taskbar from where you can initiate any search directly. It displays the search results in a small window on the desktop itself. The results window retracts after short periods of time. To amend this, right-click on the taskbar and select **Toolbars > Google Deskbar**. A small text search field appears on the right-hand corner of your Windows Taskbar. You can also configure it to open the search link inside a separate browser window. Click on the arrow beside the binoculars, and in the menu that pops up, click on Options. Here, under the Mini-viewer tab, check the 'Display search results within mini-viewer' box. Check the 'When clicking on results, open a browser' box, to open results in a separate browser window. Enable the 'Auto-

matically close the mini-viewer when you leave it' option to close the Deskbar search pop-up when your mouse cursor leaves the pop-up window area. Uncheck 'Use animated open and close' for disabling animation displays.

Other tools

Copernic Agent is another popular search tool that integrates into search engines and produces results available to them.

Download and install Copernic agent from <http://www.copernic.com/en/products/agent/download.html>. Start Copernic Agent, click on the left-hand pane and select Advanced. A small window pops up for you to enter your search. Click on 'Modify search engine settings' to open a small window that lists all the search engines it uses as reference engines—AltaVista, AOL, etc. Select all for more results, or deselect those you do not want to use. Click OK to exit.

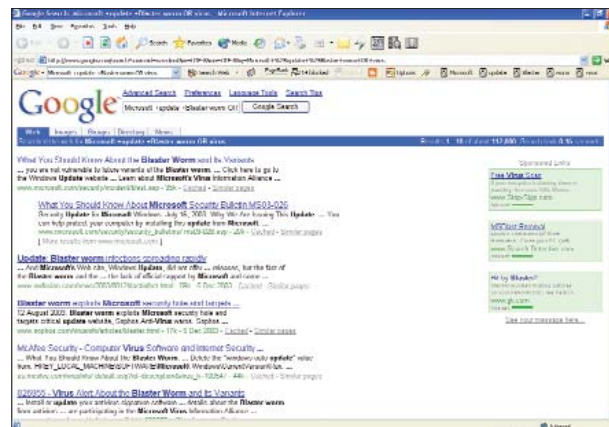
Copernic spreads a wide array of search engines at your disposal. The results are listed relevance-wise, which is indicated in percentages.

Click on the link displayed on the right-hand bottom half of the pane to browse through the results. This loads the Web site in the default browser.

Change the default browser by going to **Tools > Options > Browser**. Here, you can also specify a browser of your choice by clicking on Alternate, and specifying the path to that browser. Click on OK to close the window.

With so many search tools at your disposal, it shouldn't be difficult to find the information you require!

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